Bhardwaj Desai, MD

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CORE COMPETENCIES

- 30 years of experience and knowledge in global oncology Clinical Development and Research
- 14 years of experience in pharmaceutical industry and 16 years as Principal Investigator
- Experience in all phases of oncology drug development (pre-clinical development, clinical trial management, designing of phase I through phase III clinical trials, post-launch marketing, post- approval studies, regulatory affairs and GCP, and broad strategy development for numerous compounds)
- Have designed and executed both early phase studies for small biotech as well as helped them with late phase development and actual filing of NDA/BLA. Similar experience with large pharma as well.
- Prior experience designing, executing and successfully completing early phase studies as well as phase 2 and 3 studies in Lung cancer, Lymphoma, AML, Breast cancer, Gastric cancer, Colon cancer, Melanoma, CLL and Bladder cancer
- Worked on multiple investigational agents in hematology and oncology including PARP inhibitor, cMet antibody, LAG-3, PD-1, PI3K, CDK4/6, Claudin 18.2, EGFR, FLT3 etc.
- Experience in oncology antibody drug conjugate, small molecules, antibody, immunotherapy , cell based therapy and oncolytic virus based clinical development
- In depth experience and interaction with global regulatory authorities for IND, SPA, NDA, and CTA meetings, as well as scientific advice meetings
- Organizing advisory boards for global oncology disease specific development
- Experience in establishing and maintaining successful collaborations with NCI-CTEP, ECOG, SWOG, RTOG, etc.
- Superb communication skills; oral and written, along with exceptional leadership skills, and cross-functional collaborations in pre-clinical, clinical, medical, pipeline marketing, and regulatory activities
- Expert team player with demonstrated ability to take ownership and responsibility to drive progress
- Hands on, can-do style and attitude with the ability to organize and prioritize
- Believes in flexible, open-minded approach, empowering teammates and developing/maximizing talent

EXPERIENCE

Oncology Innovation, Chicago, Illinois **August 2017 – Present**

Chief Strategic Clinical Development Oncology Consultant

- Medical monitoring for Phase I to Phase III studies
- Successful NDAs; one for PI3Kdelta, second for relapsed DLBCL and third in Lung cancer with ownership of module 2 and 5 for NDA
- First real-world evidence-based control arm study design with FDA agreement and acceptance
- Accountable and responsible for early go/no-go criteria-based proof of concept and/or proof of mechanism study design
- Accountable and responsible for phase III, or pivotal registration study, for data quality/timeline
- Familiarity with data cleaning and safety review including SPOTFIRE and j-review
- Provide leadership, with vision and direction, to medical, clinical operations, regulatory, medical affairs, safety, and clinical pharmacology functional leadership
- Safety monitoring, including review of ongoing safety, SAE, and AE of special interest and safety narratives
- Selection of Clinical Research Organization
- Owner and author of IND and NDA filing in USA
- Global submission for CTA and NDA
- Budget and timeline for clinical development and regulatory submission
- Portfolio prioritization for Regulatory and clinical development in oncology and hematology indications

Astellas Pharma, Northbrook, Illinois **August 2015 – August 2017**

Global Medical Lead, Oncology

- Global Medical Lead for multiple oncology investigational compounds including biologics, antibody drug conjugates, and immunotherapy (including cell-based therapy and oncolytic virus compounds)

- Accountable and responsible for early go/no-go criteria-based proof of concept and/or proof of mechanism study design
- Accountable and responsible for phase III or pivotal registration study for data quality/timeline
- Responsible for development and implementation of clinical development strategy and clinical plan
- Presented to senior management for the approval of strategy and developmental plan
- External and internal communication plan for the results of the pivotal studies
- Responsible for scientific rationale and development of regulatory submission plan
- Clinical Lead for a variety oncology compounds
- Provided leadership and prioritized projects on pre-clinical and clinical drug development
- Medical Lead in oncology due diligence activities

Pfizer, Inc., Chicago, Illinois (Home Office Based) **February 2014 – July 2015**
Senior Medical Director, Oncology

- Designed and implemented clinical development strategy and clinical plan
- Presented to senior management for the approval of strategy and developmental plan
- Internal and external communication plan for the results of the pivotal studies
- Responsible for scientific rationale and development of regulatory submission plan
- Clinical Lead for a variety of oncology compounds
- Provided leadership and prioritized projects for pre-clinical and clinical drug development
- Worked with team of pre-clinical and translational scientists to develop proof of concept, as well as pivotal clinical development plan
- Designed and worked as Global Medical Lead for phase III oncology clinical studies
- Scientific and clinical representation for regulatory interactions leading to successful acceptance of phase III study design with FDA/EMA/PMDA
- Responsible for enrollment and execution of cost-efficient clinical study
- Collaborated cross-functionally with global team, including clinical operations, commercial, regulatory, and clinical pharmacology teams
- Provided scientific and medical input for the due diligence activities related to oncology pipeline

Abbott/AbbVie, Chicago, Illinois **May 2009 – January 2014**
Global Medical Director, Biologics (April 2013 - January 2014)

Hospira, Inc. (Initially part of Abbott and later acquired by Pfizer), Lake Forest, Illinois

- Primarily responsible for two BLA submissions for biosimilar compounds, one of which was accepted in EMA and Health Canada
- Successful BPD type 2, 3, and 4 (pre-BLA) meeting for initial wave of biosimilars to the FDA
- Presented scientific rationale to FDA from biosimilar perspective
- Responsible for review, and execution of development strategy for CMC (analytical), clinical, and regulatory strategy for multiple biosimilar compounds
- Provided oversight for publication planning, medical affairs related activities, and presented to potential payers for successful commercial launch
- Medical Lead for global biological development for the Company
- Planning, execution, and ownership of regulatory submission with focus on CMC and clinical overview, with integrated summary of efficacy and safety sections
- Designed and developed post approval plans for drug including labeling activity, risk management plan, publication planning, and medical information planning
- Represented the Company in joint scientific meetings with partners
- Designing phase I and phase III therapeutic equivalence clinical studies with pre-defined margin as per prior acceptance by EMA and FDA

- Regulatory interactions including MAA submission in EMA with attendance at oral explanation to CHMP with positive outcome for biosimilar compound
- Global Medical Lead on multiple biosimilar phase III studies
- Portfolio development for new biosimilar compounds
- Led medical team successfully for co-financing agreements with various partners

Medical Director (May 2009 - April 2013)
Abbott/AbbVie

- Led multiple oncology compounds, both small molecules and monoclonal antibodies, and antibody drug conjugate program with portfolio prioritizing activities
- Completed phase I to phase III clinical development
- Point of contact for global regulatory interactions, including SPA and end of phase II meetings
- Global and US advisory boards planning and execution
- Responsible for the design, development, and implementation of clinical trial protocols
- Designed and developed collaborative clinical studies in US (CTEP, ECOG, PCCTG, GOG, RTOG, SWOG, and NCCTG) as well as EU (Danish group, EORTC) and responsible for communication of results to internal and external stake holders
- Provided leadership and prioritized projects on pre-clinical and clinical drug development
- Influenced and provided strategic input with team of pre-clinical and translational scientists
- Clinical Lead for multiple oncology compounds and studies
- Provided medical/scientific consultation and therapeutic expertise
- Oversaw study specific medical/safety monitoring activities, ensuring compliance with ethical, legal, and regulatory standards for the company SOPs
- Represented the medical affairs department in business development activities
- Provided departmental oversight with people management, resource identification, and allotment
- Provided medical monitoring for clinical studies (i.e. inclusion and exclusion criteria, protocol, procedure clarifications, and waivers)
- Provided medical oversight for serious adverse event reporting and tracking, and communication of safety issues to staff, sponsors, and regulatory authorities
- Oversaw and provided consultation for clinical projects from lab report review, CRF safety review, and potential endpoint reporting
- Coordinated and provided medical training including disease specific protocol review, safety regulation, or therapeutic area presentations for clinical staff, project teams, or investigator meetings
- Reviewed and approved protocols, case report forms, informed consent forms (when applicable), and other miscellaneous study documentation
- Responsible for coordination, review, and approval of serious adverse event narratives
- Reviewed and approved final study reports and other clinical documents
- Directed code-break activities (as appropriate)
- Managed and led the drug safety associates, and other department personnel, for study and project activities
- Represented Medical Affairs at team teleconferences and meetings
- Ensured quality of medical program deliverables in accordance with quality assurance project plans and company standards
- Assisted senior medical management in ensuring departmental revenue and margin targets are met
- Updated and provided input for monthly status reports, departmental activities, and project/performance related issues

Kendle International, USA, Chicago, Illinois **September 2007 – April 2009**
Therapeutic Advisor, Oncology Clinical Development

- Led multiple oncology clinical projects, due diligence activities, and regulatory interactions for multiple biotechnology and pharmaceutical companies
- Responsible for adverse event/serious adverse event handling and reporting

- Verified the medical accuracy of patient safety data and maintained an ongoing assessment of the safety profile of the study
- Regularly reviewed serious adverse experience data and primary and secondary safety and efficacy data
- Provided medical surveillance on serious adverse event (SAE) reporting and follow-up, including afterhours coverage of medical emergencies
- Complied with all regulatory, sponsor, and Kendle guidelines for handling and reporting of SAEs
- In consultation with the sponsor, followed procedures for breaking blind studies
- Interacted with appropriate regulatory agencies concerning safety and other study related issues as requested

Clinical Medicine, India **March 1991 – September 2007**

Hematologist/Medical Oncologist

- Responsible for clinical management of oncology and hematology patients for inpatient and outpatient care
- Principal Investigator for phase I to phase IV clinical studies for multiple global studies of oncology and hematology molecules
- Member of speaker team for various pharmaceutical and biotechnology companies
- Advisor to global CRO for oncology therapeutics

EDUCATION

Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, Vadodara
Doctor of Medicine – MD, Internal Medicine Residency Program
1986-1989

The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda
Bachelor of Medicine, Bachelor of Surgery – MBBS, Medicine
1980-1986

ECFMG Certification with US Medical Licensing Exam Step 3
(Required for unsupervised medical practice in USA for foreign medical graduate)
2007

Hematology and Medical Oncology Training
1989-1992

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Naturalized US Citizen
American Society of Medical Oncology
American Society of Hematology